Improving user experience during booking of high demand live events on BookMyShow

An online event ticketing platform is a solution that lets event organizers sell tickets online for their in-person, hybrid, and virtual events more conveniently.This market is projected to grow from $1.2 billion in 2020 to $2.3 billion by 2025 in India.

BookMyShow is a dominant player in India's online ticketing market, focusing on event ticketing across categories like movies, live concerts, sports, and more.

Major Events: BMW Joytown(The Chainsmokers and Diljit Dosanjh), Coldplay Concert, Lollapalooza India, Bandland 2024 etc.

650+
Cities

20M
Ticket Sales/month

₹237cr
Revenue

90%
Market Share

4B
Page views per month

₹500-₹700
AOV

80M
User Base

(Source)

Sources of Revenue



(Source)

Actors and Constraints

1) User: Crashes during high-demand events, slow booking time, virtual queue frustration, ticket unavailability, and payment failures.

2)Event Organizers- If BookMyShow cannot manage ticket sales for large events, partners might switch to competitors

3)Advertisers-Negative publicity impacts their decision to advertise on BookMyShow

Current state of BookMyShow

The platform witnessed a significant resurgence in live entertainment post-pandemic, with over 8 million customers attending 19,000 shows in 2022, and this upward trend has continued into 2024. Tier-2 cities are also contributing to this growth.Despite of this success, BMS has faced backlash due to the inability to handle high profile client events

Value Proposition

BookMyShow offer end-to-end solutions for event-goers for booking live events tickets including pre-booking of food, merchandise, parking, and additional event services like seat selection and VIP experiences.

(Source)

Zomato District

Zomato's vast user base, brand power, strong technical infrastructure, and integration with its existing food delivery service may offer a more seamless and reliable experience for booking live events.

Threat

With fewer reports of system crashes and technical issues during large events, Zomato could poach users dissatisfied with BookMyShow

Competitor Analysis

	Insider	BookMy Show	District
Loyalty Programs	✗	✓	✗
Ticket Resale and Transfer	✓	✗	✓
Robust Payment Option	✓	✓	✓
Home-viewing event	✗	✗	✓
Combining food delivery and Entertainment	✗	✗	✓

Other Competitors

1) Ticket New- regional language support
2) Meraevent-hybrid event ticketing
3) Townscript- DIY event creation tool

Why is it important for BMS to provide a good user experience?

1. Maximizing Revenue from High-Demand Events
2. Customer Retention and Loyalty
3. Event Partner Relationships and Trust
4. Reducing the Impact of Competitors
5. Scalping Prevention and Fair Ticket Distribution
6. Advertising and Monetization Opportunities
7. Brand Reputation and Long-Term Growth
8. Operational Efficiency and Reduced Costs
9. Improving SEO

Product Outcomes

1. Increase Numbers of Bookings by maximizing the conversion rate
2. Increase the frequency of bookings made per user
3. Maintaining exclusive partnerships
4. Increased Revenue from Upselling and Advertising
5. Reduce bounce off rate
6. Reducing no. of churned users and reviving the already churned

Unit Economics

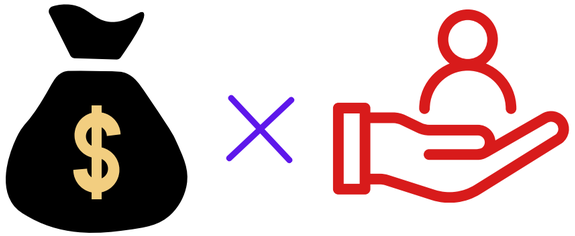
(source)

Cost Components :

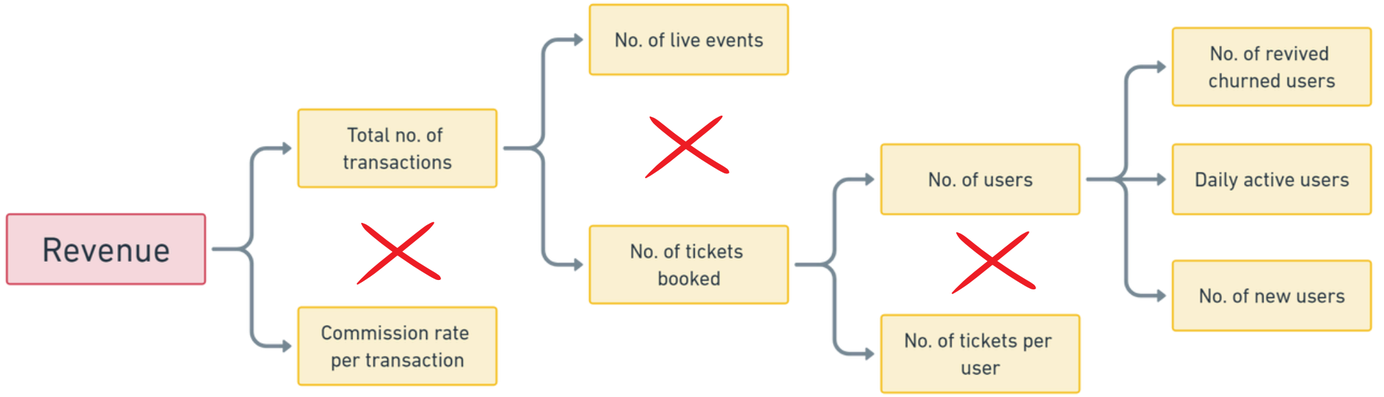
- Payment Gateway fees
- Technology Infrastructure (fixed and variable costs)
- Customer support and service costs
- Marketing and promotion
- Revenue share to event organisers
- Refund Costs

Revenue

- Ticketing Revenue
- Non Ticketing Revenue (as discussed before)



KPI Tree



CUSTOMER SURVEY

(38 Responses)

73.7% Tier-1 city users

61.1% waited for 2+ hours in the queue

82.4% Rated as poor service <5

88.5% Booked coldplay tickets on Mobile phones

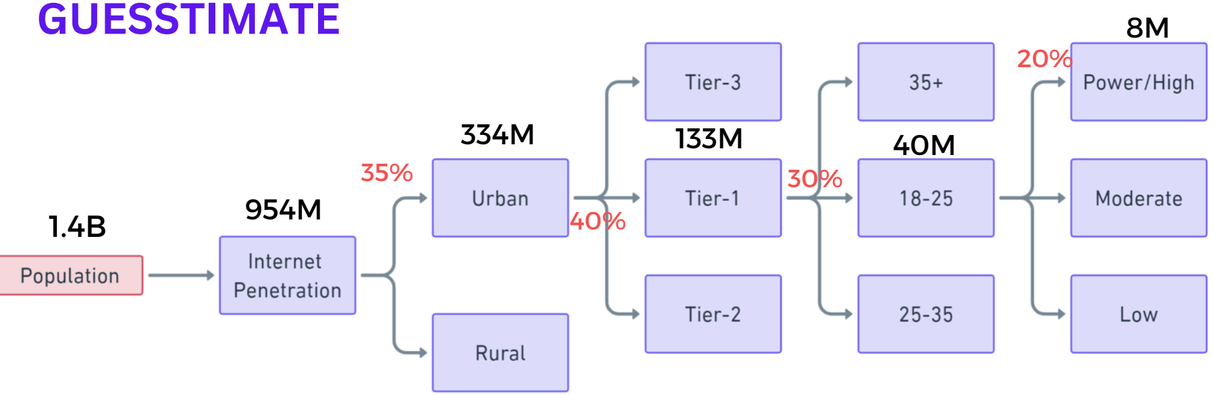
56.5% Faced system crashes

71.1% Want more discounts

65.2% Think tickets get sold out quickly

86.8% Will use BMS if issues are resolved

GUESSTIMATE



TARGET USER SEGMENT

18-25 year old + high-frequency is the core audience that drives regular ticket sales, social influence, and long-term brand loyalty

86.8% AGE:18-25

44.7% High Frequency

USER PERSONA

Krish |24| SDE | Kolkata

He has recently moved to the city for work and wants to socialize on weekends. He books tickets for live events and meets new people

Pain Points: He cannot spend lot of money every week. He is busy with work and does not prefer to wait in long queues

Needs: Offers and dicounts to continue being a high frequency user and a better queue management system.

Manya |19| Student | Bhopal

She is very passionate about music and wants to get her hands on every concert ticket happening in India.

Pain Points: She faces system crashes while booking. She also gets irritated by tickets getting sold out quickly and having to buy from other platforms at 10x price.

Needs: Seamless booking process and fair access to the tickets

Made with Whimsical

PROBLEM FRAMING CANVAS

PROBLEM BREAKDOWN

- SYSTEM FAILURE
- LONG QUEUE
- PAYMENT FAILURE
- INSTANTLY SOLD OUT TICKETS
- INADEQUATE CUSTOMER SUPPORT
- NO OFFERS AND DISCOUNTS
- LACK OF LUCK BASED TICKETING SYSTEM
- RESOLD AT HIGH PRICES

INSIGHTS FROM USER RESEARCH

- 65%+ users have faced techincal issues due to the system crash.
- Most of the genuine users are ticketless.
- 1:1 interviews highlighted that 70% users were frustrated due to scalping of tickets.
- 89% could book seamlessly on phone

WHO IS FACING THIS PROBLEM

Genuine and high frequency users between the age 18-25 years, who attend these high demand live events.

SCALPING

Scalping refers to the practice where individuals or automated bots buy large quantities of event tickets intending to resell them at much higher prices

- For Coldplay, 30% user base with disposable income can pay for the concert and make travel arrangements yet 70% attempted to book.
- 40% people bought tickets just to resell it
- Scalping bots flooded the system creating sudden surges in traffic.
- Bots occupy large chunk of queue by pushing genuine users back.

This indicates a lack of genuine traffic generated on the website

WHAT IS THE TRUE PROBLEM?

scalping abstains genuine customers from getting the tickets and scalpers cause unnecessary load on the system

HOW DO WE KNOW IT IS A REAL PROBLEM

- User interviews show that majority people bought tickets just to resell them at higher prices
- 70% frustrated with scalping

WHY SOLVE IT NOW

Helps BookMyShow protect its leadership position, foster customer loyalty, maximize revenue, and maintain partnerships while staying compliant with future regulations.

VALUE GENERATED FOR USERS

- Faster Processing: reducing waiting times, server crashes and stable transactions
- Secure Booking: Ensures that tickets go to real people, enhancing security and trust.
- Fair access and pricing, trust and loyalty

VALUE GENERATED FOR BUSINESS

- Customer Retention
- Partnership Growth: BMS retains credibility and secures future high-profile partnerships.
- Revenue Protection: prevents revenue loss to unauthorized platforms.
- Better Brand Reputation

Solutions to the problem:

(source)

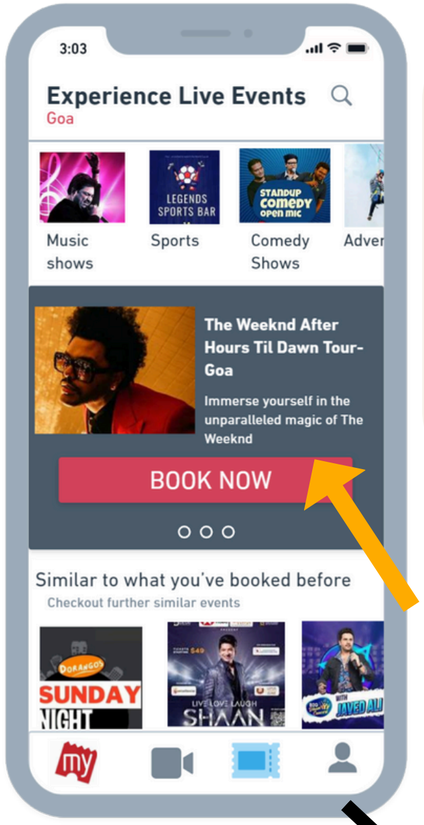
	Purchase History based Allocation	CAPTCHA and Human verification	Blockchain Ticket Verification (source)	SecureSwap
what is it	By using past purchase history as a factor in ticket allocation, BMS can ensure that genuine, repeat customers get priority access to tickets, while discouraging scalpers who are new to the platform or create fake accounts.	Use CAPTCHA on key stages like adding tickets to the cart and completing the transaction. This prevents bots from automating ticket purchases.	Issuing tokenized tickets on blockchain, BMS can ensure that every ticket is uniquely traceable, preventing unauthorized resale.	Link tickets to government-issued IDs. Allows verified users to transfer the tickets to other verified users in-case of last minute plan change.ID will be checked during event entry
How it helps the user	Genuine users who frequently purchase tickets for events will be rewarded for their loyalty. This makes long-term users feel valued, enhancing customer satisfaction and retention.	Users won't have to compete with automated systems that can buy tickets much faster than humans, improving their chances of successfully purchasing tickets.	Greater Security for Pay-ments, Increased Control for Event Organizers,Enhanced User Trust and Transparency,Preventing Scalping and Fraud	The resale market will be regulated, protecting buyers from price scams while offering genuine users a chance to transfer tickets within the platform.

	R	I	C	E	RICE Score
Purchase History	4	3	3	4	9
CAPTCHA	3	4	3	2	18
SecureSwap	5	5	4	4	25
Blockchain verification	5	5	2	5	10

Best Solution

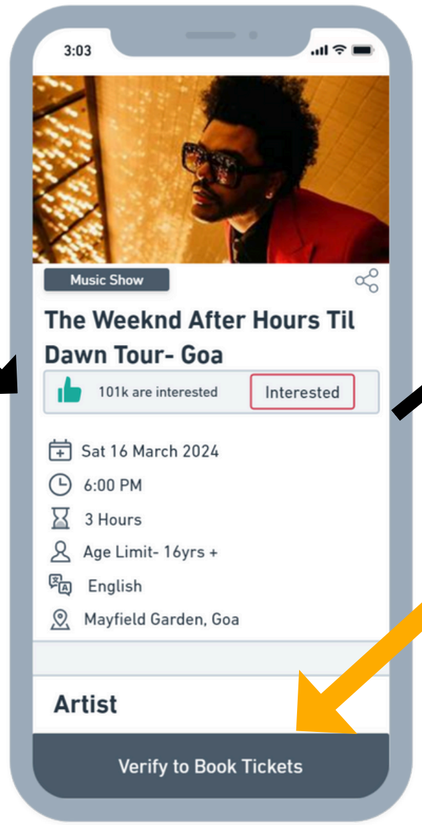


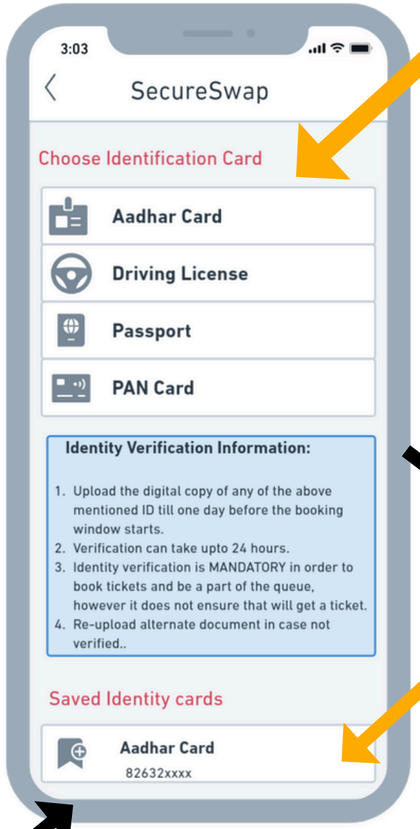
Wireframe



1.Go to Home page>>Live Events.
2.Click on Book now on the Live event you want to attend

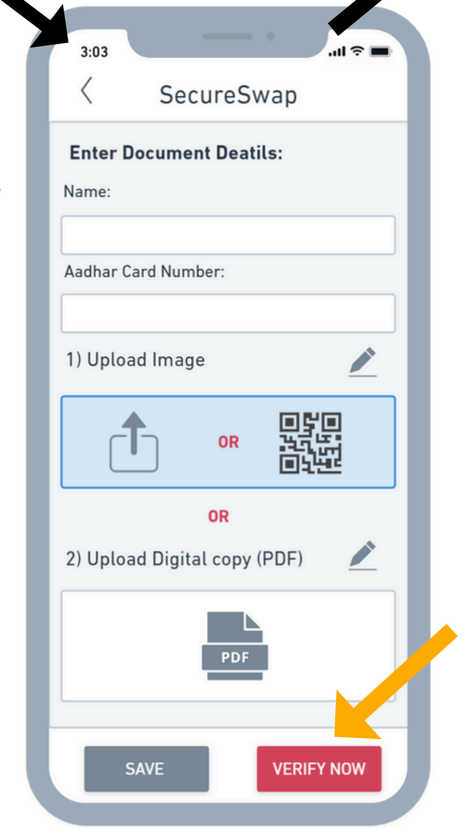
Users can proceed only after verifying their identity through a government ID(atleast one day before the booking starts)

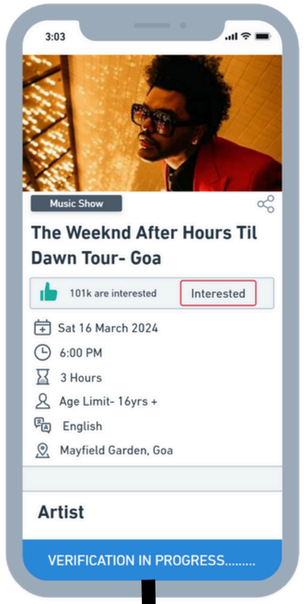


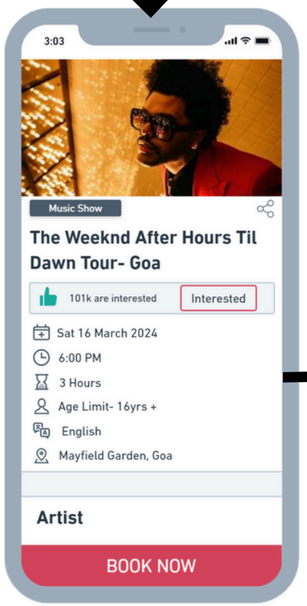


1.Introduction to **SecureSwap** feature
2.Choose preferred card or the already saved one.
3.Read the guide-lines carefully.

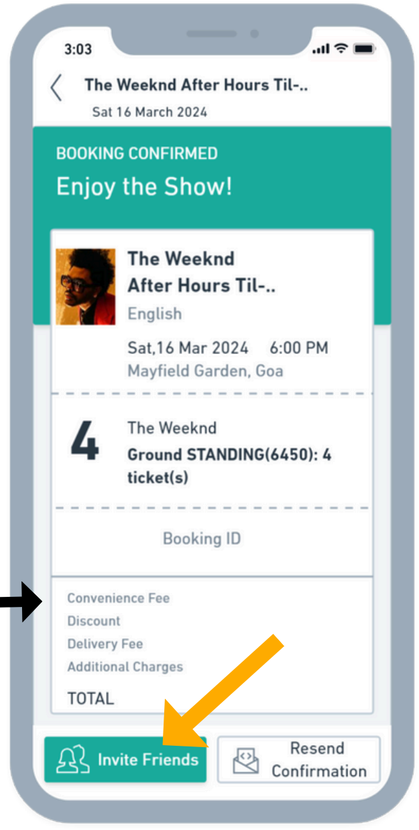
Enter your details and upload the image or PDF of your document



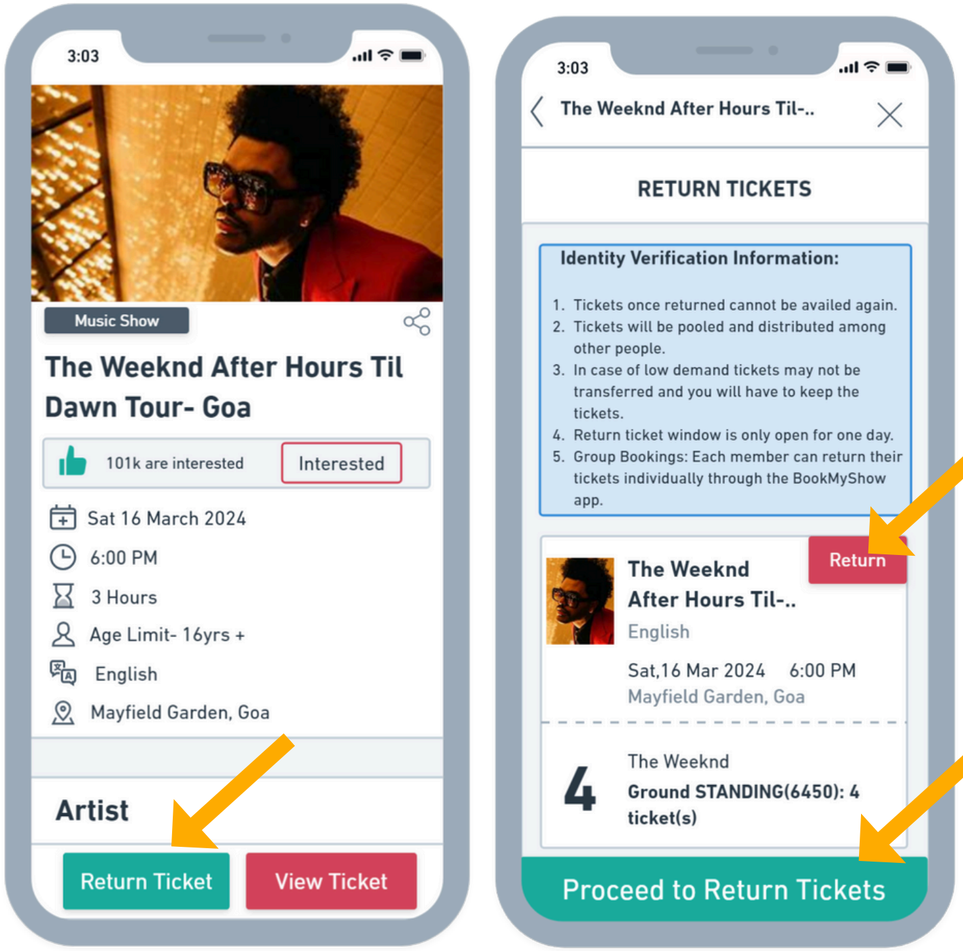




1)After verification>Book Now>Select seat>Make payment>Enter delivery address>Get Tickets
2)In case of multiple tickets ,user must email it to the other verified users in 48 hrs.

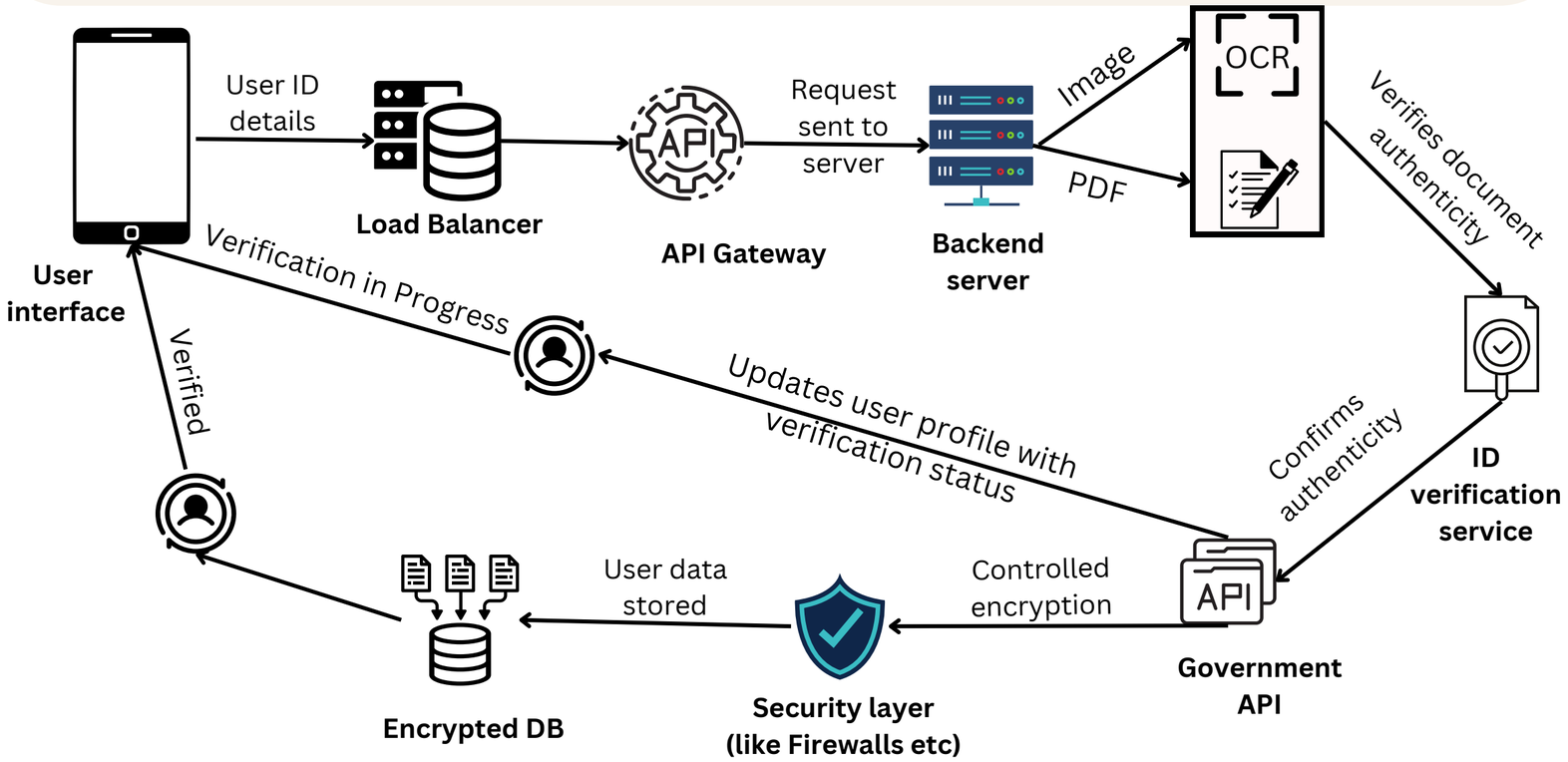


System design and Solution



SecureSwap gives the user an opportunity to return the tickets incase of last minute emergency.2-3 weeks before the event return window will open ,through which verified users can submit their tickets.

- Users need to upload a valid government ID
- Once they submit the image of pdf they have to wait for verification which takes around 24 hours .Users will be notified about verification status.
- Incase of group bookings, a user may buy maximum 4 tickets and then share it with their friends/family through mail within 48 hours.
- Friends/family need to download the app and get verified to avail the tickets.
- The tickets of the users who want to cancel will be pooled 2-3 weeks before the event depending on the supply and demand and redistributed to verified users (without a ticket) on BookMyShow platform 2 days post return of tickets window closes. User will know if their tickets have been transferred after the second round of distribution. This redistribution depends on first come, first serve basis for people returning it and the for the ones buying it.



Metrics

Metric Type	Metric	Goal
North Star Metric	Genuine User Ticket Acquisition Rate	The percentage of tickets sold to verified users who are identified as genuine (non-scalping) customers for high-demand events.
Primary Goal/ Metric	Conversion rate	The percentage of verified users who successfully book tickets
	Verified User Retention Rate	The rate at which verified users return to BookMyShow for future bookings
	Ticket Scalping Reduction Rate	Measures the decrease in scalping cases following the ID-based verification
Supporting Metrics	Verification completion time	Average time it takes for user ID verific-ation.
	User dropoff during verification	Monitors the % of users who abandon the process before completing ID verification
Guardrail Metric	System Load and Downtime	Tracks server health metrics, such as uptime and response time

Risks	Mitigation
Scalability and System Load	Leverage cloud infra-structure to scale resources dynamically based on demand and optimize data processing times
Privacy and Data Security Concerns	Employ secure data encryption and storage protocols. Limit access to ID data to essential personnel only .
Rejected Users due to Verification Failures	Implement a secondary manual verification step for users flagged by the system or allow them to contact support directly
Limited flexibility for Ticket Transfers	Communicate these policies clearly to avoid confusion or Create a verified resale forum within the BMS app